

Ball sports

Ball games have been played for at least 3,500 years, and today there are hundreds of different kinds. Some can be played by a single person, while others involve as many as 30 players and need a huge pitch to play on.



MARBLE

Two players take turns to knock an X-shaped group of marbles from a large chalked circle, by throwing one marble.



SQUASH

A game played by two people on a walled, indoor court. Players use rackets to bounce the ball off the walls and floor.



TABLE TENNIS

This fast game is also known as ping pong. Two players hit a very light ball back and forth over a small net on a special table.



GOLF

Golf is played on a huge grass course with 18 holes. Golfers use various clubs to hit the small, dimpled ball into the holes.



REAL TENNIS

The oldest racket sport, real tennis is played on an unusual indoor court. Players hit a felt-covered cork ball back and forth across a net, using wooden rackets.



TENNIS

Played on a variety of different surfaces. Players hit a felt-covered bouncy ball to each other across a net using tightly strung graphite or fibreglass rackets.



BOULES

Played outside, two teams throw large, very heavy, metal balls, "boules", towards a small target ball known as a "jack". The team that gets the ball closest to the jack wins.



HURLING

A traditional Irish game played on a grass pitch. Players use a flat-ended, curved stick to catch, bounce, and toss the ball to each other in order to score goals.



CRICKET

Two teams of 11 players each take turns to bat and field. Batsmen score "runs" by running between two areas, known as the wickets, while the other team tries to get them "out".



HOCKEY

Played on a large outdoor grass pitch by two teams of 11. Players pass the ball to each other using sticks with a hook-shaped end and try to score goals in their opponent's net.



SEPAK TAKRAW

Also known as kick volleyball, two teams of three players face each other on either side of a high net. The teams kick the ball over the net, winning a point if their opponents let the ball touch the ground inside the court.



HANDBALL

Two teams of seven players bounce and throw the ball to each other using only their hands, and try to score goals. Handball is played indoors and players can take a maximum of three steps while holding the ball.



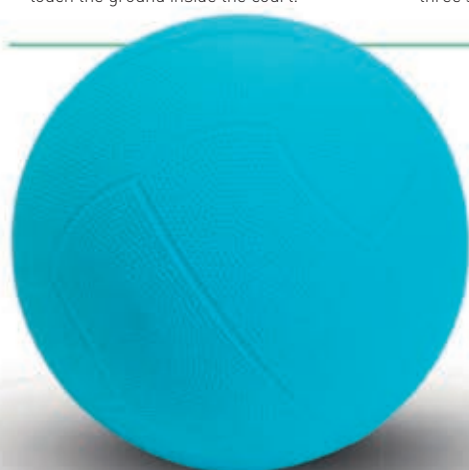
VOLLEYBALL

Two teams of six players stand on either side of a high net. One player serves the ball over the net using his or her hand and the other team must hit it back. The teams try to hit the ball back and forth, but if the ball hits the ground the other team gets a point.



BEACH VOLLEYBALL

This form of volleyball is played by two teams of two or more players on a beach or sandy court. The ball must be hit, not caught; if it touches the ground, the other team wins a point.



DODGEBALL

Dodgeball is played indoors or outdoors on a small court divided into two equal sections. Two teams of six to ten players start with three balls each, and try to hit someone from the other team by throwing the ball at them. If they succeed, that player is out – the aim is to get all the opposing players out.



NETBALL

Netball is played by two teams of seven players on a hard indoor or outdoor court. Players must not run with the ball, they are only allowed to move one foot in order to turn and pass the ball to a team-mate. The aim is to throw the ball into a netted hoop and score a goal.



BASKETBALL

Two teams of five players move the ball up and down a court by bouncing the ball with one hand as they run, or by throwing it to another team member. The aim is to score goals by shooting the ball through one of the raised hoops that sit at either end of the court. A goal is known as a "basket".